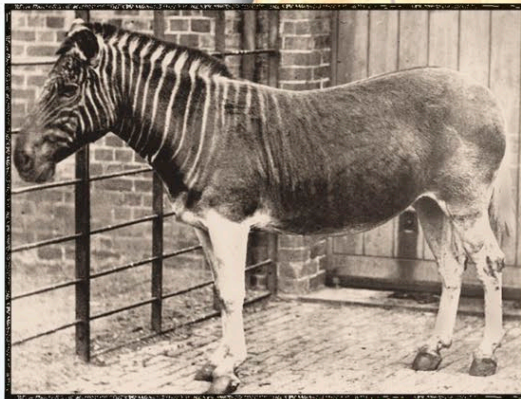




Quagga

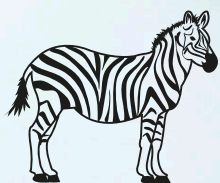
A subspecies of the plains zebra with fewer stripes, called the quagga, was once common in southern Africa, but was hunted to extinction by about 1883. Today scientists are breeding zebra with quagga-like characteristics to try to bring the animal back.

African grazers

Zebras graze on the grasses of a variety of habitats, from the plains zebra in open grasslands and savannas, to the Grevy's zebra in semi-arid scrub, and the mountain zebra on mountainous slopes and plateaus. During the dry season, the Grevy's and mountain zebras spread out further in their range to find better sources of food and water, but the plains zebra follows seasonal rains—to wherever the grass is greener—in large migrations.

Long mane

Zebras have some of the longest manes of any members of the horse family, with the stripes extending right to the black edge, which forms a crest-like fringe.



THE PATTERN OF STRIPES OF EVERY INDIVIDUAL ZEBRA IS AS UNIQUE AS A HUMAN FINGERPRINT

A GROUP OF ZEBRAS IS SOMETIMES CALLED A DAZZLE



Plains zebras

Stripes

The exact reason why zebras are striped is not known for sure. The stripes may serve as camouflage, as a social signal, or even as a deterrent to biting insects.

Black and white

Underneath their fur, zebras actually have dark skin. Their stripes develop as white over black rather than vice versa.

Zebras

Zebras are the most distinctive members of the horse family. Three species live on the grassy savannas in the eastern and southern parts of Africa, each with their own species-specific pattern of stripes.